

1949, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed draft by the
Servant of God Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Saint Felix Friary

Huntington, Indiana

July 18th, 1949

Very Rev. Father Provincial, O.F.M. Cap., Edmund

Very Rev. Dear Father Provincial:

Praised be Jesus Christ. Deo Grt. Honestly I hardly know how to begin. That million-dollar proposition has been on my mind since months before your Paternity held Visitation here last year; And the longer it go on the more it seems to me timely, opportune, urgent.

Besides the encouraging proposition of our Benefactor, Joseph J. O'Donnell of Chicago, a copy of whose letter I shall herewith enclose, there are other - quite a few, perhaps mostly religious - praying for the "million-dollar essay contest. I mentioned the proposition to Rev. Mother Mary Fidelis - helpless invalid at the time - and afterwards to about fifty of her nuns, of Notre Dame Milwaukee, the day of Unvaling Fr. Stephen's Statue and of my own very fortunate ptomane-poison experience, - anything but pleasant of course but - most profitable to my soul. I hope the students from Calvary profited too by their taste, at least, of similar experience. Deo Gr. for all His designs.

Well, Mother Mary Fidelis and her said nuns seemed quite interested and promised to pray the good God bring it to success. I had hardly come to the parlor after blessing them with several relics and a little visit in the Chapel when I urged, "Sister, please get me a vessel quickly. I'll have to vomit. I'll wait right here on the floor". Luckily nothing came but strenous reaching till the vessel arrived, and then very little, with quite a relief of very short duration - again and again - till the ambulance came and took the patient to St. Michael's Hospital ... for about 40 hours. ...